The value of sport

Lead-in

1 Rate the following sports / activities in order of enjoyment for you from 1 (most enjoyable) to 8 (least enjoyable). Doing not watching!

- Running
- Cycling
- Swimming
- Tennis
- Walking
- Bowling
- Going to the gym
- Climbing

2 What is your favourite sport? Tell your partner.

Input

1 1 Listen to this radio interview with two people talking about sports they love to do. What sports are they?

2 1 Listen again and answer the following questions.

1 When and why did Anthony start training for triathlons?
2 How far is an Olympic distance triathlon?
3 What are the benefits of the sport for Anthony?
4 Are there any disadvantages?
5 When and why did Sue start weightlifting?
6 What are the benefits of the sport for Sue?
7 Are there any disadvantages?

Language focus

1 Complete the following phrases with a preposition. When you finish, check with a partner and discuss the meaning of each phrase.

1 Anthony's friend suggested he come ..... to the running club.
2 Weightlifting helps Sue switch ..... from the stress of her job.
3 Anthony took ..... triathlons in his mid-50s.
4 Running can be hard ..... the knees and ankles.
5 After a few weeks Sue was hooked ..... weightlifting.
6 Weightlifting is great at burning ..... calories and helps to keep the weight ..... .
7 Weightlifting can build ..... muscle.

2 Complete these questions then ask a partner.

1 Which sports or activities do you think are best for switching ..... from work and other stresses?
2 Which activities do you do that burn ..... calories?
3 What was the last new sport or hobby you took ..... ?
4 What makes people get hooked ..... sports?
5 What's the best way for people to build ..... their strength and stamina after an injury?
6 Should people do sports that are hard ..... the knees?

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3 Complete the questions the presenter asks.

1 How ..... have you been doing triathlons?

2 How did you ..... started?

3 How did your first race ..... ?

4 How do you think it ..... you in your life?

5 Would you ..... it to other girls?

6 Are there any ..... ?

4 Discuss with your partner some sports that you do now or did when you were younger. Ask each other some of the questions above.

Task

1 Look at the statements from your teacher. Decide if you agree or disagree.

2 Tell your partner what you think and see if you have the same ideas.

3 In a group share and discuss your opinions. Remember to give your own stories and those of people you know to support your arguments.

4 Tell the class about one of the statements you discussed.

Review

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